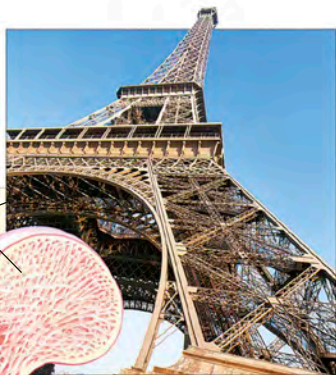


BONES

Your bones are hard and strong. They are not solid though, so they are not as heavy as you would think. In fact, they only make up 14 percent of your total body weight—they are lighter than your muscles. Bones are not dead and dry. They are living, and can repair themselves if they break. Your body is made up of lots of bones all working together and linked by joints. If you had no knee joints, you would have to walk with stiff legs.



What's inside a bone?

The outer part of all your bones is hard and tough, but the inside of many of them is spongy.

These lightweight, soft centers are crisscrossed by small struts which make your bones strong, but not too heavy. This idea of strength without weight is copied in buildings such as the Eiffel Tower.

Crisscross struts

Some bones are filled with jellylike marrow. Platelets and red and white blood cells are made in the bone marrow.

The spongy inner bone looks like a honeycomb.

Blood vessels take oxygen and food to bone cells.

Your neck is much shorter than a giraffe's, but it has the same number of vertebrae!

The tiny tailbones at the end of your spine, called the coccyx, help to support your body when you sit down.

Your two feet contain one quarter of the bones in your whole body!

